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SHOPKEEPRR

SELF-HOSTED COMMERCE

INSTALLATION & SETUP GUIDE

Your store. Your code. Your rules.

A complete, plain-language guide to installing ShopKeeprr 1.0.0, configuring payments, choosing a business model and taking your first order.

Version 1.0.0 | Laravel 13 | PHP 8.3+ | Stripe & PayPal

ShopKeeprr · A focused commerce platform by SJDesigns

Keep this guide with your purchase record. It is written for store owners, not only developers.

Before you start

READ THIS FIRST

ShopKeeprr is a self-hosted PHP application. You provide the hosting, domain and database; ShopKeeprr provides the storefront, admin panel and checkout. Nothing is sent to a mandatory SaaS service.

What you need

REQUIREMENT	WHAT TO ARRANGE
PHP 8.3 or newer	Extensions: `pdo`, `openssl`, `mbstring`, `fileinfo`, `zip`, `tokenizer`, `json`, `dom`, `libxml`. The installer checks these for you.
Database	MySQL 8+ is recommended for a live store. SQLite 3 is supported for a small store, a demo or local testing.
Web server	Apache, LiteSpeed or Nginx. The document root must point at the `public/` folder, not the project root.
HTTPS	Required for live payments, secure sessions and signed updates. Install a certificate before switching Stripe to live mode.
Writable folders	`storage/` and `bootstrap/cache/`. The installer will test them.
Outbound HTTPS	Needed for Stripe, optional PayPal, email delivery and signed updates. The store still runs if updates are blocked; you can update from the command line.

> **You do not need Node.js to run ShopKeeprr**
>
> The compiled front-end assets are included in `public/build`. Node is only needed if you change the CSS or JavaScript and want to rebuild them.

What is in the package

- ✓ The complete Laravel application, compiled storefront assets and four themes.
- ✓ A browser installer at `public/install.php` and a command-line installer.
- ✓ Three free launch modules: Product Reviews, Customer Wishlist and Announcement & Promotion Bars.
- ✓ Starter Terms of Service and Privacy Policy pages, fully editable in the admin.
- ✓ This guide, `README.md`, `SECURITY.md`, `UPDATING.md` and the automated test suite.

What is not included

Paid plugins, premium theme packages and optional business-model extensions are sold separately by ShopKeeprr Store. ShopKeeprr 1.0.0 does not contain an integrated marketplace browser; download a package from the Store and upload its ZIP in **Admin** → **Plugins**.

Upload and install

BROWSER METHOD

This is the recommended path for cPanel and ordinary shared hosting. It takes about ten minutes plus DNS and SSL setup.

1. **Create the database**

   In cPanel, open **MySQL Databases**. Create a database and a dedicated user with a strong password. Add the user to the database with all privileges. Write down the database name, user name, password and host (usually `localhost`).

2. **Upload the ZIP**

   Open **File Manager** and go to the folder above `public_html`. Upload the ShopKeeprr ZIP and choose **Extract**. You should end up with a folder such as `/home/youruser/ShopKeeprr`.

3. **Point the domain at public/**

   In cPanel → **Domains**, set the document root to `/home/youruser/ShopKeeprr/public`. If you use a subdomain, set its root to the same folder. Never expose the project root, `.env`, `storage/` or `database/`.

4. **Open the installer**

   Visit `https://your-store.com/install.php`. The server check confirms PHP, extensions, folder permissions and the ability to run the installer. If a check fails, fix it before continuing.

5. **Enter the database**

   Choose MySQL and enter the database details from step 1. The installer tests the connection before it writes anything.

6. **Create the store and owner account**

   Enter the store name, public email, URL, country, currency and your administrator name, email and password. Choose Retail, B2B Wholesale, Subscription Box or Multi-Vendor Marketplace. You can change the model later.

7. **Finish**

   Click **Install ShopKeeprr**. The installer writes `.env`, generates the application key, runs migrations, creates the administrator, seeds optional demo data and writes a lock file. It shows the storefront and admin URLs when it finishes.

> **Delete or rename install.php after setup**
>
> The installer locks itself after a successful run, but removing `public/install.php` removes an unnecessary public entry point. Keep a copy outside the web root in case you need to inspect it later.

Install without proc_open

COMMAND-LINE FALLBACK

Some shared hosts disable `proc_open`, which the browser installer uses to run Artisan. The installer detects this and saves your database and store details, then shows exact commands to finish.

Option A — finish from the saved payload

Upload the project, create the database, and run the installer until it gives you the fallback screen. Then open cPanel Terminal or SSH and run:

```
cd /home/youruser/ShopKeeprr
php artisan config:clear
php artisan migrate --force
php artisan shopkeeprr:install --data="/home/youruser/ShopKeeprr/storage/app/install-payload.json"
```

The payload contains the database and store details you entered. It is removed after a successful install.

Option B — install entirely from the command line

```
cd /home/youruser/ShopKeeprr
composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader
cp .env.example .env
php artisan key:generate

# Edit .env first: APP_URL, DB_*, MAIL_*
php artisan migrate --force
php artisan shopkeeprr:install \
  --store-name="My Store" \
  --admin-email=you@example.com \
  --admin-password="a-long-password" \
  --mode=retail \
  --demo
```

`--mode` accepts `retail`, `b2b`, `subscription` or `multivendor`. Add `--live` to open the storefront immediately. Use `--force` only when intentionally reinstalling over an existing lock.

> **The old command still works**
>
> `php artisan nexus:install` remains an alias for existing deployments. New installations should use `shopkeeprr:install`.

After either method

- ✓ Set `APP_ENV=production`, `APP_DEBUG=false` and the real HTTPS `APP_URL`.
- ✓ Run `php artisan config:cache` and `php artisan route:cache`.
- ✓ Add the scheduler cron entry so unpaid orders are cancelled and modules can run scheduled jobs.
- ✓ Sign in at `/admin` and change the owner password if you used demo data.

```
* * * * * cd /home/youruser/ShopKeeprr && php artisan schedule:run >> /dev/null 2>&1
```

First-run setup

ADMIN CHECKLIST

Complete these steps before you send the store URL to a customer. They prevent the most common launch problems.

Store identity

- ✓ Store name, public email, address and currency.
- ✓ Logo or wordmark, favicon and brand colours.
- ✓ Terms of Service and Privacy Policy reviewed for your business.
- ✓ Refund, shipping and contact pages linked from the footer.

Catalog

- ✓ Create categories before products.
- ✓ Add at least one product with price, stock, image and description.
- ✓ Set tax and shipping rules for your country.
- ✓ Test search, filters, cart and a guest checkout.

Payments

- ✓ Start in Stripe test mode and complete a test purchase.
- ✓ Add the webhook endpoint and test a signed event.
- ✓ Test a full and a partial refund.
- ✓ Switch to live keys only after the test flow passes.

Email and operations

- ✓ Configure SMTP and send a test order receipt.
- ✓ Test password reset and the admin login.
- ✓ Confirm the scheduler runs every minute.
- ✓ Take a database backup and store it off-server.

Choose the right business model

MODEL	USE IT WHEN	WHAT CHANGES
Retail	You sell a normal catalog to everyday shoppers.	Standard catalog, guest checkout and retail pricing.
B2B Wholesale	You approve trade accounts and sell at tier prices.	Wholesale applications, customer price tiers, minimum order quantities and hidden guest prices.
Subscription Box	You charge recurring plans.	Subscription plans, customer self-service and renewal state. Stripe or PayPal handles the recurring charge.
Multi-Vendor	Independent sellers share one storefront.	Seller accounts, seller portal, commission rules and split payouts through Stripe Connect or PayPal Payouts.

> **Switching models later is supported**
>
> ShopKeeprr runs a preflight check, archives products that do not belong in the new model and preserves historical orders and seller obligations. Review the warning list before confirming. A model switch is not a substitute for a backup.

Themes and Storefront Builder

You do not need a developer to change the homepage. The theme gallery controls the overall look; the Storefront Builder controls the sections on the page.

Theme gallery

Open **Admin → Theme**. Four presets are included: Editorial, Marketplace, Auction House and Global Bazaar. Each has a coordinated palette and typography, so you can switch without picking colours that clash. Activate a preset, then adjust the brand colour, accent colour and fonts if you want a closer match to your logo.

Storefront Builder

Open **Admin → Storefront builder**. The live storefront appears on the right and the section library on the left.

Drag a section onto the page: hero, featured products, categories, testimonials, countdown, newsletter, trust bar, promo or product grid.

Click text in the preview to edit it directly. Use the section settings for images, links, colours and spacing.

Switch between desktop, tablet and mobile previews. Reorder sections by dragging.

Save a draft, review it privately, then publish. The public homepage stays unchanged until you publish.

What the builder is good for

- Seasonal hero images and launch announcements.
- Moving featured products above categories.
- Adding social proof, countdowns and newsletter signup.
- Testing a layout without touching Blade templates.

When to edit a theme file

- You need a layout the builder does not provide.
- You are building a custom child theme for a client.
- You need new product-card behaviour or a custom checkout step.

Drafts are private

A saved draft is visible only to signed-in administrators and is marked `noindex`. Customers keep seeing the published page until you press Publish.

Payments, refunds and webhooks

ShopKeeprr supports Stripe and PayPal behind one payment contract. Stripe is the recommended default because it covers cards, wallets, Link and marketplace payouts in one integration.

Stripe setup

Open the Stripe Dashboard → Developers → API keys. Copy the **test** publishable and secret keys.

In ShopKeeprr, open **Admin** → **Settings** → **Payments**, choose Sandbox and paste both keys. Save.

Add a webhook endpoint at `https://your-store.com/webhooks/stripe`. Subscribe to payment success, payment failure/expiry, refund and chargeback events.

Copy the webhook signing secret into the Stripe webhook field and save again.

Make a test purchase with a Stripe test card. Confirm the order becomes paid, stock is reserved and the receipt is sent.

Issue a partial refund from the order screen. Confirm the gateway refund and the order refund total agree.

Only then switch to Live keys and a Live webhook secret.

PayPal setup

PayPal uses its REST client ID and secret. Create a sandbox app in the PayPal Developer Dashboard, paste the sandbox credentials, and add a webhook pointing at `https://your-store.com/webhooks/paypal`. Test a sandbox capture, a refund and a duplicate webhook delivery before switching to live credentials.

> **Test mode is not live readiness**
>
> A sandbox payment proves the code path. It does not prove your live account, bank settlement, tax settings, statement descriptor or dispute handling. Complete at least one low-value live purchase and refund before announcing the store.

What the webhook protects

- Only a signed event can mark an order paid.
- The amount, currency and order number must match.
- Duplicate deliveries are recorded once.
- Dashboard refunds and chargebacks are reconciled.
- Late payments reopen a cancelled order where possible.

Refunds

- Full and partial refunds from **Admin** → **Orders**.
- The remaining refundable balance is enforced server-side.
- A refund form token prevents double submission.
- Refunds still work after a gateway is disabled for new orders.

Legal pages, modules and updates

Terms of Service and Privacy Policy

Starter pages are created during installation and linked from the storefront footer and checkout. Open **Admin → Pages** to edit either page. Use the **Restore starter legal pages** button only if you want to replace your current wording; it overwrites both pages.

> **These are templates, not legal advice**
>
> The starter text is generic. Replace the placeholders with your legal entity, address, jurisdiction, refund policy, data practices and contact details. Have a qualified professional review both pages before you take real orders.

Installing a module or theme

Download the ZIP from ShopKeeprr Store or receive it from the developer.

Open **Admin → Plugins** and upload the ZIP.

Read the trust warning. Modules are executable PHP code with application-level access. They can read the database, run migrations and call external services.

Install and enable the module. Take a database backup first.

For a theme package, follow the package instructions; themes are not installed through the module uploader.

> **Only install code you trust**
>
> A module is not sandboxed. A malicious module can access customer records, orders and payment settings. The upload screen requires an explicit acknowledgement, but that acknowledgement is not a security review.

Lifetime updates

Open **Admin → Updates** to compare your version with the signed release manifest. Review the release notes, changed-file list and module compatibility warnings before approving. The updater enables maintenance mode, writes a database dump and a ZIP of every file it replaces, applies the release and verifies the result. A failure triggers automatic rollback.

```
php artisan shopkeeprr:update --check
php artisan shopkeeprr:update
php artisan shopkeeprr:update --status
php artisan shopkeeprr:update --rollback
```

The same flow is available over SSH. The old `nexus:update` command remains an alias. Full recovery details are in `UPDATING.md`.

Troubleshooting and FAQ

WHEN SOMETHING IS WRONG

The installer says the database connection failed.

Check the host, database name, user and password. In cPanel the user and database are usually prefixed with your account name. Confirm the user is attached to the database with all privileges. On MySQL 8, the host is normally `127.0.0.1` or `localhost`.

The page is blank or shows a 500 error.

Set `APP_DEBUG=true` temporarily, reload once, then read `storage/logs/laravel.log`. The most common causes are a wrong document root, missing PHP extensions, unwritable `storage/` or a stale config cache. Set debug back to false afterwards.

CSS or images are missing.

Confirm that `public/build` and `public/uploads` were uploaded and that the document root is `public/`. If you changed front-end source, run `npm ci && npm run build`.

My payment succeeded but the order is still pending.

The webhook did not reach the store or the signing secret is wrong. Check the Stripe/PayPal webhook delivery log, confirm the URL is public HTTPS and inspect `storage/logs/laravel.log`. Do not mark the order paid manually until you understand why the event failed.

Can I change business models after launch?

Yes. ShopKeeprr previews the change, archives incompatible products and preserves historical orders. Take a backup first and read every warning. Products that do not belong in the new model are hidden from the new catalog but are not deleted.

Can I sell on Codester or CodeCanyon too?

The ShopKeeprr core is sold through independent marketplaces and the official ShopKeeprr Store. Review each marketplace's current license and exclusivity terms before uploading the same package to more than one place. Do not promise support terms that conflict with the marketplace listing.

Does ShopKeeprr require a license key?

No. License activation is intentionally disabled in the core application. The Store can record purchases and issue licenses for developers who need them, but a license server is not in the checkout path and cannot lock a buyer out of their own store.

What happens to my data during an update?

The updater backs up the database and every file it will replace before changing anything. A failed update restores both. A successful update can be rolled back later, but the database returns to its pre-update state, so orders placed after the update are removed. Read `UPDATING.md` before a major release.

Is there a demo?

Yes. The installer can seed a demo catalog, customers, orders and subscriptions. Demo customers receive a random password generated per installation and written to `storage/app/demo-credentials.txt`. Delete the demo accounts and that file before going live.

Where do I get paid plugins and premium themes?

ShopKeeprr Store. The core package includes three free modules. Paid modules, premium themes and optional business-model extensions are separate purchases and are installed from their ZIP packages.

> **Keep these three things safe**
>
> Your `.env` file, your database backups and your Stripe/PayPal credentials. Never send them by email or paste them into a support ticket. If a key is exposed, rotate it in the gateway dashboard immediately.

Launch checklist

SIGN OFF IN ORDER

Technical

- ✓ HTTPS active and `APP_URL` correct.
- ✓ `APP_ENV=production` and `APP_DEBUG=false`.
- ✓ Document root points at `public/`.
- ✓ Cron runs `schedule:run` every minute.
- ✓ SMTP sends a real order receipt.
- ✓ Database backup restored once on staging.
- ✓ `install.php` removed or renamed.
- ✓ Demo accounts and demo credentials file removed.

Commercial

- ✓ Terms, Privacy and Refund pages reviewed.
- ✓ Support email and response window published.
- ✓ Products, prices, tax and shipping checked.
- ✓ Stripe live purchase and refund completed.
- ✓ Order receipt and admin notification received.
- ✓ Store URL, admin URL and recovery path recorded.
- ✓ Update manifest and signing key backed up offline.
- ✓ Launch announcement and social preview checked.

Do not launch on sandbox credentials

If the store still says Sandbox in **Admin** → **Settings** → **Payments**, it cannot take real money. Switch to live keys, update the webhook secret and complete one real low-value transaction before announcing.

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This guide describes the core application. ShopKeeprr Store, premium themes and paid modules are separate products with their own documentation.